



Phorid flies lay eggs inside some ants.

When finding leaves, a scent is left for others to follow.

Soldier ants will bite attackers to defend the colony.

Fungus garden

Leafcutter ants chew the leaves into a pulp, which they feed to the fungus.

Gardener ants look after the fungus.

Waste, such as dead ants, is taken to the dump by waste-handlers.

The fungus eats the leaves to grow.

Queen ants can lay up to 200 million eggs. These turn into maggot-like larvae.

Larvae turn into hard pupae, which become ants.

Nurse ants care for the eggs, larvae, and pupae.

Dumps can spread diseases.

Rubbish dump

Waste is stored in special chambers. It is then carried out and dumped a safe distance away from the nest.

Old food and dead ants can lead to disease.